

JESSE VISCARRAT

IN SHORT: You used to be a carny. Now you're a burglar.

THE WORST THING THAT EVER HAPPENED

TO YOU: You'd been with the Starr Brothers Carnival for eight years when Mustang Pete lost his goddamn mind, kicked over a fifty-gallon drum of fuel oil onto the back of a tent full of rubes, lit it on fire, and shot them up one by one as they ran out the exit. Cook Juanita and Cross-Eyed Denny tackled him from behind and beat his ass so hard he could only mumble at his trial, so no one ever knew what sent him over the edge. No one but you.

Little traveling carnivals were already on the skids when this went down—thanks a lot, golden age of TV—and there was no way the Starrs were going to recover from that kind of publicity. People were already filming the show with their cell phones when it all kicked off. The image of a burning tiger isn't anything you'll forget, ever.

You were in the tent. You tried to get them out. You succeeded... for some of them. Not as many as you wanted. Better than nothing.

You were better than nothing.

WHERE YOU ARE NOW: Straight jobs in the straight world look askance at a resumé with eight years of "guessed people's weight," "ran a zamp," "contortionist," and "told fortunes." As for the carnivals, they're hardly hiring, especially not people with the stink of a jinx like the Starr Brothers fire. So you turned to crime. Starting from the not-so-honest Starr Brothers Carnival, it wasn't a sharp turn.

You worked the short con for a while, but it's exhausting and not really to your taste. Then you met Doctor A and found out just how much better you could do with burglary. Especially occult burglary.

YOUR INTRODUCTION TO THE OCCULT:

Carny folk are already liminal. "Liminal" is a word educated folks like Doctor A use to describe something in between, like someone who's dying but not dead, or a place that's neither civilized nor wilderness. Carnivals' in-betweenness stems from being a place that moves, from the illusion and delusion, from the crowds' willing belief in the falsehood. So it's already primed for magick. There are dozens of rituals, superstitions, seemingly nonsense phrases that you always speak while setting up so all hell doesn't break loose.

Mustang Pete got possessed. Something *took him*, took the "him" part of him and left the body doing something else's chores. Chores like setting fire to a crowd who just wanted to see some clowns and animals on a Friday night.

Doctor A figured it all out, explained what the thing was, while you explained how it had gotten there and what it had done. Between the two of you, you got a pretty good grip on it. The thing that ate Mustang Pete's mind is now locked in a battery, inside a flashlight, stuffed inside a fake Fiji mermaid, locked in an old milk canister wound with chains at the bottom of Lake Michigan.

You and the doc are always on the move, partly to make sure something like Mustang Pete's fire never happens again... partly because when you're a burglar, you don't want to get found. Especially when you're burglarizing occultists.

WHY ARE YOU WILLING TO DRIVE TO CANADA AND ROB A MUSEUM?:

On the southern leg of your circuit, you checked in with Guadalupe, this herb-worker out of New Mexico. She told you that the world started going screwy in 2003 (as everyone knows), and that one part of it was this big rock carved into a head. It got taken out of some native mound in Ohio and sent to a museum in Quebec. Guadalupe says getting that back where it came from is crucial to restoring the balance of the cosmos, or some shit. Plus, you owe her \$2,000 and if you steal the head, she'll cancel the debt. So, at least you'd be restoring the balance of your checkbook.

A COUPLE OTHER THINGS YOU SHOULD

KNOW: The year is 2017 and you don't speak French.

THE REST OF THE CREW

- **Dr. Angel Culbard:** Not the first person you've seen get fascinated with weird nonsensical stuff, but... maybe the best one? Doctor A came to it late in life, which seems to be a stabilizing influence. Also, not to put a fine point on it, Doctor A is a little more *financially* stable.
- **Karen Conti:** For a no-kidding reality-breaking adept, she's surprisingly chill and easy to deal with. She has a little of that detached distracted impracticality, but don't they all?
- **Cloisonné Farr:** Karen's daughter, fresh out of high school and sharp. You'd like to think the boring world of careers and college is for her, but it probably isn't. You're teaching her how to palm cards and drill locks.
- **Lee Ybarra:** Probably the one you're emotionally closest with. Both of you have seen some shit, that's for sure—your fire, Lee's stuff fighting overseas. You're cool about Lee needing canes or the wheelchair sometimes. Carny life has a pretty high

percentage of maimed folks in it, per capita.
Most times you forget about the injury.

YOUR RITUALS

The Silver Crossicle: To cast this, you need a small silver object that's a cross from one perspective, and a circle from another. (Yours was made by cutting to the center of two 1956 Walking Liberty half-dollars and wedging them into each other.) When you arrive in a new town, tie a string around it and bury it where you're staying while making an invocation in Ciazarn (the carny equivalent of pig Latin) for protection. The crossicle soaks up bad luck and malignant influences while you're there, and after you leave you just have to pull it up by the string and wash it in white liquor to rinse away all the bad stuff. Don't touch the silver until it's washed. (Do this to get one free good-luck reroll per game day.)

Whimmybam Shoes: To cast this, you need a pair of shoes with six different kinds of bottle-caps attached to the soles. (You, of course, own such a pair.) While wearing these, you can walk with a particular syncopated rhythm that makes it hard for people to tell where you are or where you're going. It's not flawless, it's not invisibility or anything, but it helps. (You get one free flip-flop in a Pursuit where you're fleeing.)

The Ol' Loop-Flop: The ol' loop-flop involves speaking rapidly while waving around a twenty-dollar bill (American or Canadian, both work fine). Your talk must have weird rhythms and confusing puns, with just enough sense to keep the target from walking away and giving up. After confusing the mark, roll for the ritual. If it works, the mark enters a susceptible state. They won't clearly remember you or your interaction if you immediately make a Lie or Connect attempt, regardless of whether that roll fails or succeeds. You do have to give them the \$20 though. Even slipping it undetected into their clothes works.



Name: Jesse Viscarrat
Cabal: Headhunters
Current Objective: Steal a 600-pound stone head from a museum in Quebec.

Distinguishing Characteristics:

RAGE Dumb folks with advantages

NOBLE Prefers to punch up

FEAR Going to jail

Lee

55% Favorite
(Status)

Karen

60% Guru
(Notice)

Doctor A

50% Mentor
(Connect)

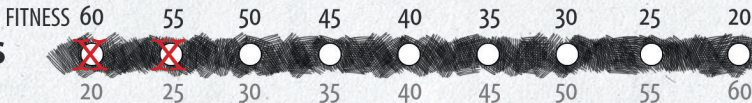
The Cabal

50% Responsibility
(Knowledge)

Cloisonné

55% Protégé
(Fitness)

HELPLESSNESS



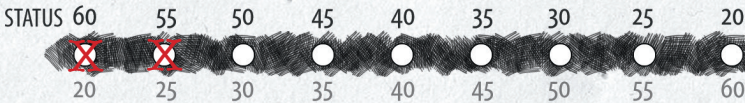
FAILURES



Defend with Status
Attack with Connect

DODGE

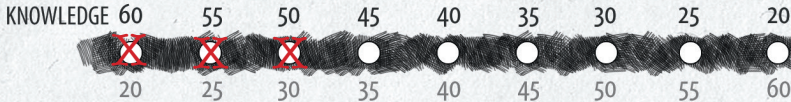
ISOLATION



Defend with Connect
Attack with Status

PURSUIT

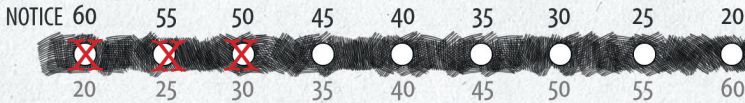
SELF



Defend with Notice
Attack with Knowledge

LIE

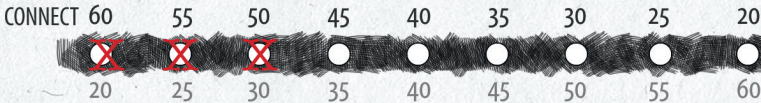
UNNATURAL



Defend with Knowledge
Attack with Secrecy

SECRECY

VIOLENCE



Defend with Fitness
Attack with Struggle

STRUGGLE

**WOUND
THRESHOLD**

50

IDENTITIES

I'm a former carny, of course I can
rig a game, guess your weight, speak the lingo
Failed! ☐ **55** %

Substitutes for Ability: Lie

Feature: Substitutes for Struggle

Feature: Casts Rituals

I'm a , of course I can
Failed! ☐ %

Substitutes for Ability:

Feature:

Feature:

I'm a , of course I can
Failed! ☐ %

Substitutes for Ability:

Feature:

Feature:

I'm a , of course I can
Failed! ☐ %

Substitutes for Ability:

Feature:

Feature:

00305

1. **65** %

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AL3-X & D3R

2. Obsession
Margins and the
outside

2a. I'm a BURGLAR

2b. Of course I can
climb, pry and jimmy, pickpocket, misdirect

Failed! ☐

3. Substitutes for Ability: Secrecy

4. Feature:

Substitutes for Pursuit

5. Feature:

Unique: Burglarize

Form **NORMAL TPS-83**

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